

"I HAVE PLUNGED INTO THIS BUSINESS TO EARN money, generate employment and ensure quality products to buyers."

KAUSHALENDRA, SAMRIDDHI, 27



Making a Difference

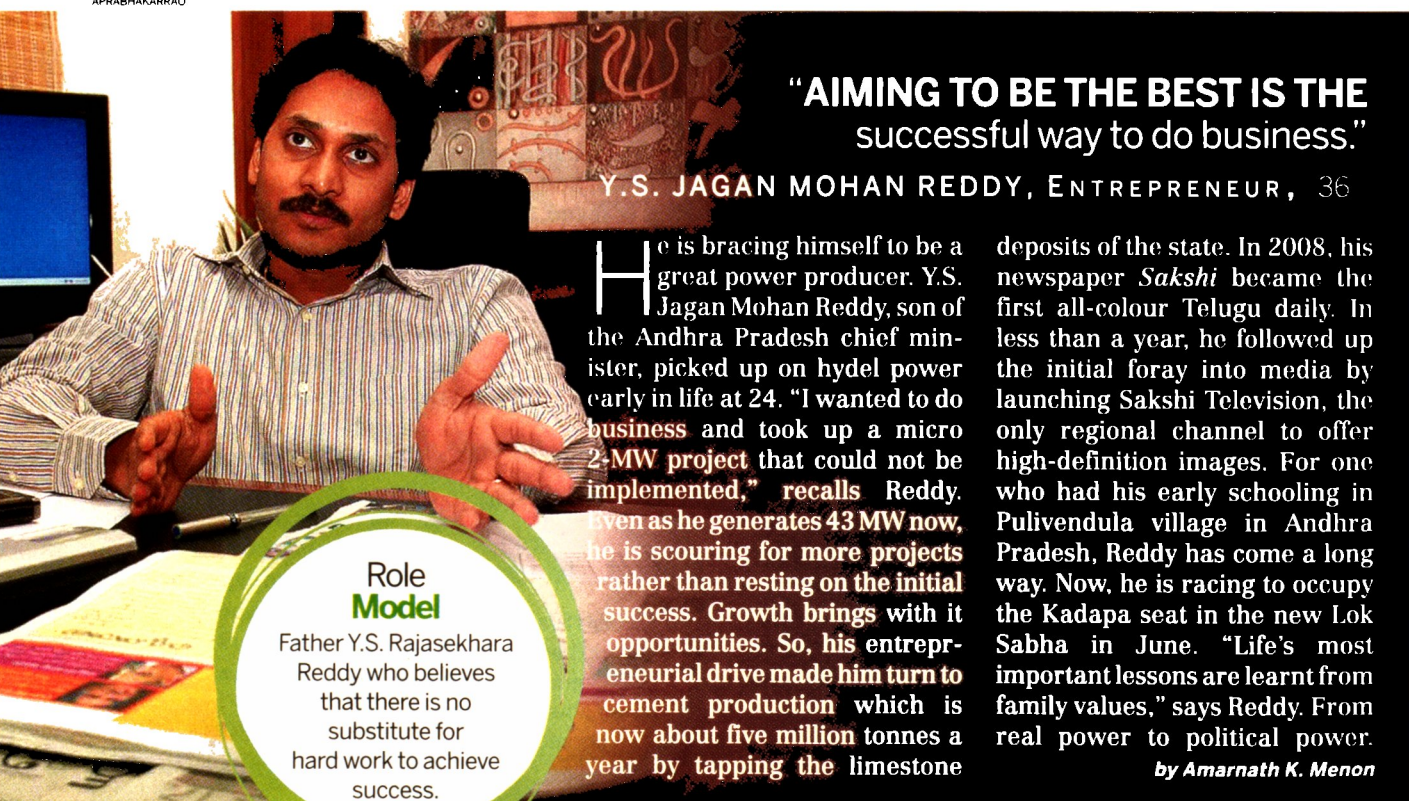
Kaushalendra's friends call him the most highly-educated green grocer India has ever produced.

Imagine a boy from the Mahmmadpur village of Bihar taking an education loan of Rs 5 lakh to complete a degree from IIM-A. Who then stays away from campus placements and decides to sell vegetables. Where pray? In Bihar. That's exactly what Kaushalendra, 27, did. He knew it wasn't going to be easy. Besides integrating potential business associates, like a roadside vegetable vendor in Patna and a farmer in a faraway village in Nalanda district, he also had to convince his parents, who initially thought their son had taken leave of his senses. He laid the foundation of a farmers' cooperative, Samriddhi, under which he established a supply chain to deliver fresh vegetables, picked up directly from the fields, to his outlets in Patna and Lucknow, to be sold in

specialty-designed ice-cooled pushcarts. Almost two years later, his cooperative earns Rs 4-5 lakh every month and employs over 1,000 people. Besides working for the farmers, Kaushalendra also keeps the consumers happy by making special efforts. He arranges free home delivery of vegetables, besides offering a kilo of potatoes free with every purchase of 2.5 kg of any vegetable. "We keep the consumers informed on healthy eating. No wonder we are rocking," he says. Kaushalendra has succeeded in inspiring confidence in his elder brother, Dhirendra, who left his job as lab technician to join him. With Dhirendra, by his side, the balding, bespectacled and ever-smiling Kaushalendra knows he can manage it all.

by Amitabh Srivastava

APRABHAKARRAO



"AIMING TO BE THE BEST IS THE successful way to do business."

Y.S. JAGAN MOHAN REDDY, ENTREPRENEUR, 36

He is bracing himself to be a great power producer. Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy, son of the Andhra Pradesh chief minister, picked up on hydel power early in life at 24. "I wanted to do business and took up a micro 2-MW project that could not be implemented," recalls Reddy. Even as he generates 43 MW now, he is scouring for more projects rather than resting on the initial success. Growth brings with it opportunities. So, his entrepreneurial drive made him turn to cement production which is now about five million tonnes a year by tapping the limestone

deposits of the state. In 2008, his newspaper *Sakshi* became the first all-colour Telugu daily. In less than a year, he followed up the initial foray into media by launching Sakshi Television, the only regional channel to offer high-definition images. For one who had his early schooling in Pulivendula village in Andhra Pradesh, Reddy has come a long way. Now, he is racing to occupy the Kadapa seat in the new Lok Sabha in June. "Life's most important lessons are learnt from family values," says Reddy. From real power to political power.

by Amarnath K. Menon

Role Model

Father Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy who believes that there is no substitute for hard work to achieve success.